# Introduction to Veterinary Terminology

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# 7.1 Introduction to Terminology for Small Animals

## Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you should be able to

1. Identify common anatomical landmarks in dogs and cats
2. Define sex and age-specific terms for dogs and cats
3. Describe the diversity of breeds present in dogs and cats, and how it might affect personality
4. Identify common coat colours and their terms in dogs and cats
5. Describe common husbandry procedures, forms of enrichment, and training equipment in dogs and cats
6. Define different ways of feeding and types of food given to dogs and cats
7. Describe the abbreviation AAFCO and its role in pet food

8. Discuss the diseases protected by the core vaccines in dogs and cats
9. Describe the importance of parasite prevention in dogs and cats
10. Identify some common routine and emergency causes for veterinary visits for dogs and cats

## Chapter Overview

In this chapter, we will discuss terminology related to dogs and cats.

We will explore the different terms associated with their anatomy, colours, breeds, and husbandry. We will also discuss some principles of feeding dogs and cats, as well as some common reasons they visit veterinary clinics.

The purpose of this chapter is to familiarize you with the general care of cats and dogs, which will help you when booking appointments and discussing health conditions of pets with clients.

# 7.2 Cat and Dog Species Terms and Anatomy

## Species Terms

You are certainly familiar with terms such as "cat" and "dog." However, in the veterinary field we sometimes refer to these species by an adjective relating to their scientific name.

**Table showing common names and adjectives for cats and dogs**

| Common Name | Adjective |
|---|---|
| Cat | Feline |
| Dog | Canine |

Within every species, we have unique names for different age and sex groups. This is especially important in production animals and breeding animals, so these terms are used more frequently for large animals than for companion animals.

We often spay or neuter our dogs and cats, but tend to just state their reproductive status rather than using a different term. Knowing reproductive status is very important, as it can help the veterinarian rule out certain diseases.

## From Head to Toe

The following table discusses some of the common anatomy landmarks you will hear in companion animal medicine.

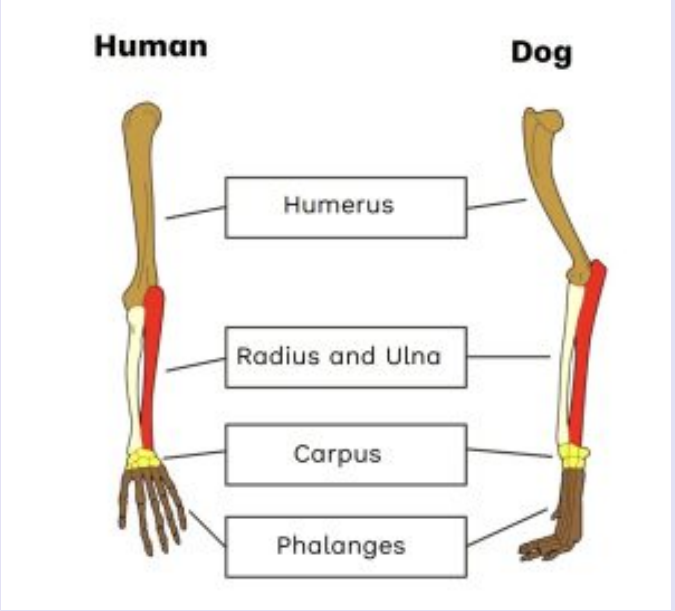



*Figure 7.1 Comparative anatomy*

## Dogs

The following image shows the locations of the terms discussed above on a picture of a dog.